

Western Digital coming in at second place. The gap however widened quite a bit with Seagate securing a score of 90.6 and WD weighing in at 66.2. In most parameters such as after sales service, loyalty, and awareness Seagate and Western Digital were always in the lead. There were some interesting upsets though. For instance more people find the exact models that they're seeking for Sandisk rather than Western Digital, in their towns and cities.

Interesting findings

- The fresh results still reaffirm Seagate's hold on consumer sentiment. A whopping **61%** of the respondents first think of Seagate when they think of external storage (unaided recall).
- For open-ended recall questions many of the respondents entered product lines such as Passport or Data-Traveller instead of Western Digital or Kingston.
- Twice the number of people own Seagate drives as compared to Western Digital
- For Corsair **20.2%** of exposure to the brand came by way of reviews compared to **13.4%** from ads.
- Seagate and Sandisk score the highest on availability of service centers – **54.2%** and **43.1%** respectively.
- **36 %** of respondents would recommend Toshiba products to their friends

SanDisk, Transcend, and Kingston (in that order) complete the top 5, and this, to us, is

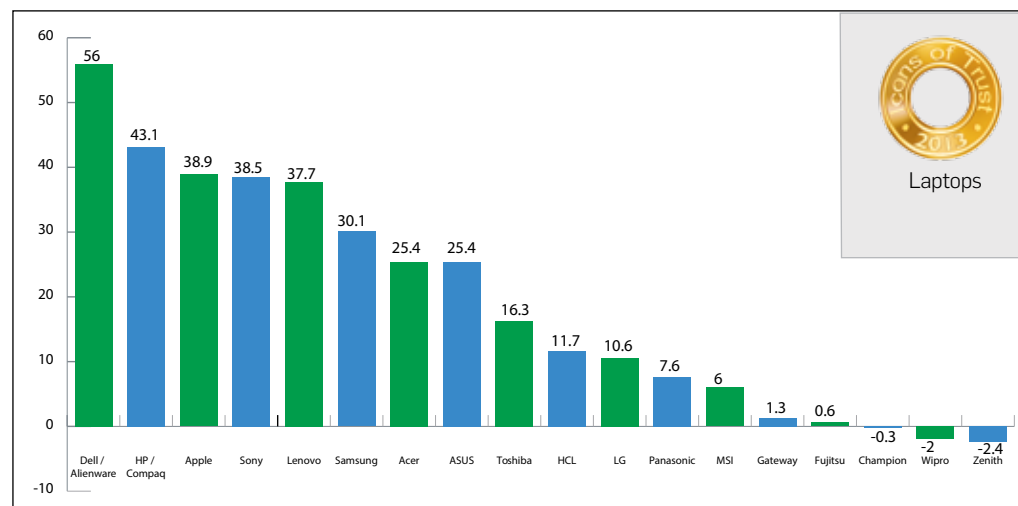
evidence of the growing importance of Flash in the external storage market. Of these three

brands Sandisk's products are perceived to be more reliable by those who took the survey.

Laptops

Looking at developments in today's portable computing landscape, it would be a misnomer to call them laptops anymore. We've got ultrabooks, convertibles, hybrids and ultraportable notebooks as form factors to choose from within this space. Together they started outselling desktops long ago and are obviously the next wave of computing. Last year we predicted ultrabooks will define this year's IOT scenario, which is pretty much what has happened.

The brands that made it to this year's top five remain unchanged. What was unexpected though was the internal



shuffling between these positions. Sony was second last year but this year it lost two places and went down to number four. This is a testament to the other brands resolutely pushing ultrabooks to the consumer. HP came



up a notch and is now at second place. Apple is at number three while Lenovo is at fifth place. The undisputed winner and most trusted brand is of course Dell – the same as last year. Dell remains firmly lodged in this top spot since 2009, when it jumped five places to get there. Going by Lenovo's efforts over the past year we were surprised to see this one time IOT winner still stuck at number 5.

Despite all of the action so far, we look forward to the results for next year's Icons of Trust. Windows 8 based hybrids and convertibles will take things to a whole new level. Brands such as Acer and Asus are consolidating efforts in this space and coming out with a slew of innovative products. **4**

Interesting findings

- Dell had the most recall value amongst all of the brands. **46%** of the respondents instantly thought of Dell when thinking of Laptops as a category. This is way ahead of HP which was the second most recalled brand with a recall value of just **15%**.
- As expected a staggering **95%** people agreed at some level thought that Apple makes stylish and well designed products.
- Lenovo products were perceived to be slightly more reliable than Sony.
- More people own Dell and HP laptops than most other brands combined. 28% of the respondents own Dell machines while **19%** own HP.
- Only **51.30%** of the respondents knew Panasonic was into Laptops. Similarly only **51.30%** people knew about MSI's Laptop product lines.
- In terms of awareness, **41.30%** of the respondents say they got exposed to Lenovo products through friends and acquaintances who owned Lenovo products – the highest for any brand. Similarly **25%** of the respondents got exposed to ASUS products through reviews (again the max score across brands)